How This Book Is Organized

This book is divided into four parts.

In the first part, we'll install and start using the tools we need to get Rails working with the JavaScript ecosystem. We'll start with a basic introduction to installing the front-end Rails tools. Then we'll add Turbo to the mix for richer interactions, sprinkle that with Stimulus, and then see how React can interact with Rails. Then we'll augment both tools by looking at some great ways to use CSS tools in our applications. Finally, we'll take a closer look at our foundation, including the basics of TypeScript and the Rails 7.0 bundling tools.

The second part has a deeper look at TypeScript and the bundling tools. In the third part, we take a look at one important concern for front-end code: communicating with the server. Then we'll look at managing the state of the data in your client-side application. We'll look at a JavaScript pattern called a reducer and then talk about Redux, a library that implements the reducer pattern and is commonly used with React.

The fourth part is about validating your code. We go further into TypeScript and take a look at how we can use the type system to prevent error conditions. We then talk about debugging and testing our applications.

Finally, in the appendix, we'll rewrite all of the book's code, first rewriting the React code using Hotwire, then flipping the script and rewriting the Hotwire code using React.

By the end of the book, you'll have options that will show you how to structure your code for different levels of client-side needs.